

Unit 9

Maps and Scale



Chapter Outline

9.1 Introduction

9.2 Scale

9.3 Measurement of distance between places

9.4 Measurement of area

9.5 Enlargement and reduction of maps

Learning Objectives:

- *Know about the types of maps and scales.*
- *Convert the scales from one form to another.*
- *Draw the various types of scale.*
- *Identify the components of the map.*

9.1 Introduction

A map is a visual representation of an entire world or a part of the earth, represented on a flat surface drawn to scale. Maps attempt to represent both physical and cultural features like relief, climate, natural resources, political boundaries, roads, population, economic activities and so on.

Components of a map

Basic Components of a map are title, legend, direction, scale and source. It gives the extent of latitude and longitude of the area mapped.

Title

Title tells about the content of the map and is placed mostly at the top centre or at the bottom centre of the map.

Scale

The scale of the map is ratio between two places on the map and their corresponding distance in the ground. It can be expressed as statements, representative fraction, or as linear scale. The scale of a map should be placed at a prominent place. It can be placed just below the title or somewhere at the bottom.

Legend

It explains about different signs and symbols used in a map and is usually placed at the left or right corner at the bottom of the map.

Direction

It is a convention that top of the map is oriented towards north and this is

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